TOUCH ENGLISH™
SPEAK WITH CONFIDENCE

STUDENT WORKBOOK · LEVEL 2

Say Which Matters More: Experience or a Certificate

Express Opinion | OREO | Mini Talk + Questions

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Say which matters more for a job, experience or a certificate, support it with one reason and one example, and answer a simple question.

WHO You work in a small company in Johor Bahru. The company is hiring a second accounts assistant to work with Mei Ling.

SITUATION Two people are on the list. One has a diploma and one year of work. The other has no diploma but six years of work. Both ask for RM2,800 a month.

NEED At Monday's meeting Mr. Tan asks you: what matters more for this job, experience or a certificate? He wants a view, not a name. Month-end here means about 400 invoices, and a new person needs about two weeks to learn our system.

GOAL Say which matters more for this job, give one reason and one example, say your opinion again, and answer Mr. Tan's questions.

Person 1

- Diploma in Accounting
- 1 year at an audit firm in JB
- Learned the new e-invoice rules at college

Person 2

- No diploma (SPM only)
- 6 years doing the accounts for a hardware shop in Skudai
- About 300 invoices a month, on the same software as ours

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Mr. Tan asks: “So, for this job, what matters more to you: experience or a certificate?” Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Mei Ling’s answer. Mark where each part starts.

Personally, I think experience matters more than a certificate for this job. The main reason is that month-end is very busy here, so the new person must do real work from the first week. For example, the second person already does the accounts for a hardware shop in Skudai: about 300 invoices a month, on the same software as ours. So for a busy office like ours, I think experience is more important than a diploma.

O OPINION

R REASON

E EXAMPLE

O OPINION AGAIN

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Siti gives her view on the office first-aider. Put her sentences in order: Opinion → Reason → Example → Opinion.

- ☐ For our office first-aider, I feel the certificate matters more than experience.
- ☐ That’s why I think the certificate is more important here.
- ☐ This is because a wrong move can hurt someone, and the course teaches the right steps.
- ☐ For instance, the course takes two days, and on day two everyone must pass a CPR test.

Write the letter: **O** = Opinion · **R** = Reason · **E** = Example · **O** = Opinion again

SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

SAY WHICH MATTERS MORE

- [ ] I think … matters more than …
- [ ] In my opinion, … is more important.
- [ ] Personally, I think …

GIVE A REASON

- [ ] The main reason is that …
- [ ] This is because …
- [ ] …, so …

GIVE AN EXAMPLE

- [ ] For example, …
- [ ] For instance, …
- [ ] I know someone who …

KEEP IT TO THIS JOB

- [ ] For this job, …
- [ ] In a small office like ours, …
- [ ] Not for every job, but here …

SAY IT AGAIN

- [ ] So overall, …
- [ ] That's why I think …
- [ ] So for this job, …

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. The second person uses the same software as us. [but / so / because] She can start quickly.

2. A diploma is useful. [so / but / For example,] Six years of work teaches you more.

3. I think the certificate matters more for a first-aider. [but / so / because] A wrong move can hurt someone.

4. You learn a lot by doing the job. [So / For example, / However,] My neighbour has no diploma, but he fixes almost every computer problem in his office.

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. I think experience _____ more for this job. (An opinion about now)
   - ○ matters
   - ○ to matter
   - ○ mattering
2. The second person _____ the accounts for a hardware shop. (A fact about now (he, she, it))
   - ○ do
   - ○ doing
   - ○ does
3. For this job, experience is _____ than a diploma. (Comparing two things)
   - ○ more important
   - ○ importanter
   - ○ most important
4. The diploma _____ help her with the new e-invoice rules. (Possible, not certain)
   - ○ mights
   - ○ might
   - ○ is

SLIDE 09 more … than · may / might

To say which matters more, compare the two with more … than. Use may / might when something is possible, not certain.

Experience **matters more than** a certificate.

For a first-aider, the certificate is **more important than** experience.

Six years of work is **more useful than** one year at an audit firm.

The diploma **may** help with tax. The new person **might** need two weeks.

SLIDE 10

Build your message

Fill each part with your own idea. You will use the same parts in the task.

O OPINION

Personally, I think … matters more than …

R REASON

The main reason is that …

E EXAMPLE

For example, …

O OPINION AGAIN

So for this job, …

SLIDE 11 Mini Talk + Questions

Give a short talk: which matters more for the job on your card, with one reason and one example. Your listener writes a note and asks one question. You answer.

1. Round 1 (3:00 each): say your card number. Listener asks the card question. Speaker: O → R → E → O, then answer.
2. Listener: fill the note. A line is empty? Ask for it (Why? How many?). Full? Ask: Is that true for every job?
3. Swap roles. Then line B moves one seat toward seat 1. Round 2 (2:00 each): same card, new listener, shorter.
4. Line B moves again. Round 3 (1:00 each), frames closed. Listener: no question; write the choice and one number.

Card 1 · A photographer for the annual dinner

Card 2 · A supervisor for the warehouse

Card 3 · A helper for Ali in IT

Card 4 · A designer for the company website

Listener's note

	ROUND 1	ROUND 2	ROUND 3
Card · opinion at end?			
Matters more			
Their reason			
Example: what, how many			

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Mr. Tan asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. Why is that more important for an accounts job?
2. How long does a new person need to learn our system?
3. Is that true for every job, or only for this one?

Start with: **The main reason is that … · It takes about …, so … · Not for every job, but for this job …**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

Your sister needs a maths tutor for her son's SPM. One tutor is a trained teacher with 1 year of tuition; the other has no teaching certificate but 10 years of tuition. Your sister asks you: what matters more?

For a tutor, I think … matters more. · The main reason is that … · For example, … · So for this, …

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

- [ ] Says clearly which matters more for the job.
- [ ] Supports it with one reason and one example (a number, a place or a time).
- [ ] Says the opinion again at the end.

SLIDE 15

Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

Clear opinion	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Reason + example	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Opinion again at the end	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Useful expressions	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3
Confidence	○ 1	○ 2	○ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review

SLIDE 11

Listener cards: fold or cut

Only the listener looks at a card. It says what to find out and write in the note.

Card 1 · A photographer for the annual dinner

Ask: 'For our annual dinner photographer, what matters more: experience or a certificate?' Fill the note. A line is empty? Ask for it: 'Why?' 'How many?' Full? Ask: 'Is that true for every job?'

Card 2 · A supervisor for the warehouse

Ask: 'For the new warehouse supervisor, what matters more: experience or a degree?' Fill the note. A line is empty? Ask for it: 'Why?' 'How many?' Full? Ask: 'Is that true for every job?'

Card 3 · A helper for Ali in IT

Ask: 'For Ali's new helper, what matters more: experience or a diploma?' Fill the note. A line is empty? Ask for it: 'Why?' 'How many?' Full? Ask: 'Is that true for every job?'

Card 4 · A designer for the company website

Ask: 'For our new website, what matters more: the designer's experience or a diploma?' Fill the note. A line is empty? Ask for it: 'Why?' 'How many?' Full? Ask: 'Is that true for every job?'

SLIDE 11

Speaker cards: fold or cut

Only the speaker looks at a card. The listener keeps this page folded.

Card 1 · A photographer for the annual dinner

Both charge RM900. Photographer 2: no certificate, about 200 weddings in 8 years, most in gardens. The dinner: 120 guests in a hotel hall, one night only. Photographer 1: a college certificate, 3 dinners in hotel halls so far.

Card 2 · A supervisor for the warehouse

Same pay for both. Person 1: a storekeeper in our Senai warehouse for 7 years, no degree, knows all 900 products. The warehouse has 8 workers. Person 2: a degree in business, 1 year in the office of a supermarket.

Card 3 · A helper for Ali in IT

The office has 15 computers; last month a virus stopped 4 of them. Person 1: Diploma in IT, 1 year at a bank's help desk. Both ask for RM2,600. Person 2: no diploma, 5 years repairing laptops and phones in Taman Molek.

Card 4 · A designer for the company website

The website must take orders online and be ready in 6 weeks. Designer 1: no diploma, about 40 websites in 5 years, none with orders online. Both charge RM4,000. Designer 2: a design diploma, 1 year at an agency, 2 online shops.